

ANX-PR/CL/001-01

LEARNING GUIDE

SUBJECT

95000315 - Professional Use Of The English Language

DEGREE PROGRAMME

09BM - Grado En Ingenieria Biomedica

ACADEMIC YEAR & SEMESTER

2025/26 - Semester 2

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1. Description

1.1. Subject details

Name of the subject	95000315 - Professional Use Of The English Language
No of credits	6 ECTS
Type	Basic
Academic year of the programme	Second year
Semester of tuition	Semester 4
Tuition period	February-June
Tuition languages	English
Degree programme	09BM - Grado en Ingenieria Biomedica
Centre	09 - E.T.S. De Ingenieros De Telecomunicacion
Academic year	2025-26

2. Faculty

2.1. Faculty members with subject teaching role

Name and surname	Office/Room	Email	Tutoring hours *
Cristina Zimbroianu (Subject coordinator)	C-204	cristina.zimbroianu@upm.es	Sin horario. To be confirmed
Javier Herrero Ruiz	C-204	javier.herrero@upm.es	Sin horario. To be confirmed

* The tutoring schedule is indicative and subject to possible changes. Please check tutoring times with the faculty member in charge.

3. Prior knowledge required to take the subject

3.1. Prerequisite (passed) subjects

-
-
-

3.2. Other required learning outcomes

The subject - other required learning outcomes, are not defined.

4. Prior knowledge recommended to take the subject

4.1. Recommended (passed) subjects

The subject - recommended (passed), are not defined.

4.2. Other recommended learning outcomes

- In order to enrol for this course, students are required to provide an approved certificate of at least B1 (CEFR) level in English. In order to pass the course, students are required to provide a B2 official certificate 5 working days before the exam.

5. Skills and learning outcomes *

5.1. Skills to be learned

CE50 - Capacidad de comprender y expresarse de forma oral y escrita en inglés a nivel profesional científico-técnico.

CG13 - Ser capaz de colaborar con grupos internacionales, interdisciplinares y multiculturales.

CG15 - Transmitir la información adquirida, las ideas, los problemas y las soluciones de forma oral y escrita en castellano e inglés.

5.2. Learning outcomes

RA55 - Elaborar documentos y preparar presentaciones para difundir los resultados de los trabajos

RA98 - Adquirir terminología propia de ciencias de la salud.

RA128 - Desarrollar la capacidad de presentación oral pública.

RA125 - Desarrollar la capacidad de realizar un trabajo en equipo, en la planificación del trabajo común, la búsqueda de fuentes de información y la presentación de resultados.

RA165 - Presentar de forma oral o escrita las conclusiones más relevantes de un trabajo de investigación

RA164 - Realizar búsquedas bibliográficas y extraer/analizar las conclusiones más importantes

* The Learning Guides should reflect the Skills and Learning Outcomes in the same way as indicated in the Degree Verification Memory. For this reason, they have not been translated into English and appear in Spanish.

6. Brief description of the subject and syllabus

6.1. Brief description of the subject

Theoretical sessions: teachers will present the main discursive and linguistic contents in English applying the flipped classroom ("clase invertida") methodology, which will result in a constant exercise of listening comprehension and note taking for the students. Other methodological approaches followed in this course are: task-based, Learning-by-Doing and Communicative approaches.

Workshops: besides presenting the basic theoretical features, a varied range of activities will be carried out, both individually and in groups (class workgroups will be set up at the beginning of the semester). Some listening comprehension exercises and oral tasks will be based on live events and recorded videos and audios related to biomedical engineering topics, and professional and business situations (e.g., job interviews, oral presentations, discussions, technical talks, etc.).

Practical sessions (both with previous preparation and spontaneous): in-class debates on controversial ethical and professional issues. Note-taking exercises on listening activities and technical lectures in English.

Attendance and participation (when required): in academic seminars and technical lectures held at the ETSI de Telecomunicación or offered by other organizations. Interviews with professionals working in biomedical companies.

Individual and group assignments: students will have to hand in different assignments (face-to-face and recorded) along the semester.

Office hours: they will be organized according to the University regulations in force. Students will be able to contact their teachers via email. English is welcome as the main language to be used both in emails and during the office hours.

Through the listening and viewing of comprehension activities of specialized topics in the field of biomedical engineering, students will get familiarized with content and terminology of the field and its correct pronunciation and stress.

6.2. Syllabus

1. General Characteristics of academic and professional technical writing: Weeks 1 and 2

1.1. How to write objective, clear and concise texts.

1.1.1. Terms and other lexical features of academic and professional texts

2. Adapting your texts to different settings: Purpose, audience and context: Week 3 and 4

2.1. Formal vs. informal style: contrastive analysis of e-mails, letters and other technical texts

2.2. Clarity, Conciseness and Accuracy:

2.2.1. Conciseness: Reduction of adverbial time clauses and relative clauses, avoiding redundant and pompous words, and correct use of effective nominalizations.

2.2.2. Gender issues in writing

2.3. 2.3. Accuracy: Revision of the most typical grammatical and discursive problems when writing in English

3. Developing an academic or professional text: Weeks 5 and 6

3.1. Structuring the introduction, paragraphs and conclusion

3.2. Structuring the abstract

3.2.1. Organizational structure

3.2.2. Deductive vs. inductive organization

3.2.3. Techniques to begin an introduction

3.2.4. Developing Paragraph and Textual Patterns: chronological order, cause-effect, problem-method-solution, general-specific, specific-general, from most to least important, from least to most important, comparison and contrast, enumeration, exemplification.

3.3. Rhetorical Functions: Definition, Classification, Physical Description and Process Description

3.4. Reading and analysis of different technical texts on topics related to biomedical sciences

4. The Final Project Work: Technical Report Writing (Informational and Evaluative Reports): Weeks 7 and 8

4.1. Introduction: background, aim, sources of information

4.2. Main Body Paragraphs: application, advantages, challenges, future developments, etc.

4.3. Conclusions

5. Other academic and professional documents: Week 9

5.1. The Curriculum Vitae

5.2. The Letter of Application / Letter of Motivation

6. Oral Presentations: Week 10

6.1. Elements of an oral presentation: Preparation, audience, eye contact, use of voice and use of time

6.1.1. The Structure of the Oral Presentation: The introduction, the main body, the end and the delivery

6.2. General rules of pronunciation, intonation and stress

7. Corporate cultures in biomedical companies: Week 11

7.1. Corporate cultures and work styles

7.2. Searching for a job

8. The Job Interview: Week 12

8.1. Selection techniques and types of job interviews

8.2. The structure of the job interview

8.3. Preparation of the job interview

8.4. Practice of job interview in groups

9. General overview of meetings: Week 13

9.1. Types of meetings: Informal and formal, brainstorming, decision-making, problem-solving, speed meetings, elevator pitch, job interviews, teleconferencing, etc.

9.2. Organizing, chairing and taking part in meetings and discussions

10. Oral Presentations Practice: Weeks 14, 15

7. Schedule

7.1. Subject schedule*

Week	Type 1 activities	Type 2 activities	Distant / On-line	Assessment activities
1	Course presentation Duration: 01:00 Lecture General Characteristics of academic and professional technical writing Duration: 01:30 Problem-solving class Soft skills. Writing process. Duration: 01:30 Problem-solving class			
2	Formality vs. Informality Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class Email-writing & phoning workshop Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class			In-class participation in activities of various kinds Individual work Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00
3	Reading activity and specialized vocabulary Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class In-class participation in activities of various kinds Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class			In-class participation in activities of various kinds Individual work Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00
4	Clarity and conciseness Duration: 01:00 Problem-solving class In-class participation in activities of various kinds Duration: 03:00 Problem-solving class			In-class participation in activities of various kinds Individual work Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00
5	Paragraph structuring and reading Duration: 02:00 Lecture In-class participation in activities of various kinds Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class			In-class participation in activities of various kinds Individual work Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00

6	Definitions, physical and process descriptions. Listening activity. Specialized vocabulary. Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class In-class participation in activities of various kinds Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class			In-class participation in activities of various kinds Group work Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00
7	Abstract writing & summarising. Reading activity Duration: 02:00 Lecture The Final Project Work: Technical Report Writing (Informational and Evaluative Reports) Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class			In-class activity: abstract analysis first non-recoverable task Individual work Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00
8	Writing an Evaluative Report. First Recoverable Task Duration: 02:00 Additional activities Writing an Evaluative Report. First Recoverable Task. Duration: 02:00 Additional activities			Writing an Evaluative Report: First Recoverable Task Group work Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00
9	Curriculum Vitae, Application and Motivation Letters Duration: 01:00 Problem-solving class Writing an application letter: Second non-recoverable task. Duration: 01:00 Additional activities Reading activity Duration: 00:30 Problem-solving class Specialized vocabulary Duration: 00:30 Problem-solving class In-class participation in activities of various kinds Duration: 01:00 Problem-solving class			Writing an application letter. Second non-recoverable task. Individual work Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00
10	Oral Presentations Duration: 01:30 Problem-solving class Pronunciation and listening activity Duration: 00:30 Problem-solving class Oral presentations: introduction strategies, the main body, the closing, pronunciation rules.			In -class participation and activities of various kinds. Group work Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00

	Duration: 01:00 Problem-solving class In-class participation of activity of various kinds Duration: 01:00 Problem-solving class			
11	Corporate cultures and work styles. Searching for a job. Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class Digital Europe: The Sustainable Development Goals Duration: 01:30 Problem-solving class In-class participation in activities of various kinds Duration: 00:30 Problem-solving class			In-class participation in activities of various kinds Individual work Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00
12	Job Interviews: techniques and types of job interviews. Preparation of a job interview. Duration: 01:00 Problem-solving class Oral presentations. Signposting Duration: 01:00 Problem-solving class Listening activity and specialized vocabulary Duration: 00:30 Problem-solving class Mock job interview: Third non-recoverable task. Duration: 01:30 Additional activities			Mock job interview: Third non-recoverable task Group presentation Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00
13	Meetings: General Overview. Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class Types of meeting: organizing and chairing a meeting Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class			In-class participation of activities of various kinds Group presentation Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00
14	Oral presentations. Duration: 02:00 Additional activities Oral presentations in groups Duration: 02:00 Additional activities			Oral presentations in groups: Second recoverable task Group presentation Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00 Oral presentations in groups Group presentation Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00

15	Oral presentations in groups Duration: 02:00 Additional activities In-class participation in activities of various kinds Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class			Oral presentations in groups Group presentation Progressive assessment Presential Duration: 00:00
16	Content review Duration: 02:00 Problem-solving class Description of the final exam, doubt clearing session. Duration: 02:00 Additional activities			
17				Exam including all the content of the course. Written test Global examination Presential Duration: 03:00 Written proposal (also if failed or not delivered previously). Written test Global examination Not Presential Duration: 00:00 Oral presentation (also if failed or not delivered previously). Other assessment Global examination Presential Duration: 00:00

Depending on the programme study plan, total values will be calculated according to the ECTS credit unit as 26/27 hours of student face-to-face contact and independent study time.

8. Activities and assessment criteria

8.1. Assessment activities

8.1.1. Assessment

Week	Description	Modality	Type	Duration	Weight	Minimum grade	Evaluated skills
2	In-class participation in activities of various kinds	Individual work	Face-to-face	00:00	30%	5 / 10	
3	In-class participation in activities of various kinds	Individual work	Face-to-face	00:00	%	/ 10	
4	In-class participation in activities of various kinds	Individual work	Face-to-face	00:00	%	/ 10	
5	In-class participation in activities of various kinds	Individual work	Face-to-face	00:00	%	/ 10	
6	In-class participation in activities of various kinds	Group work	Face-to-face	00:00	%	/ 10	
7	In-class activity: abstract analysis first non-recoverable task	Individual work	Face-to-face	00:00	10%	5 / 10	
8	Writing an Evaluative Report: First Recoverable Task	Group work	Face-to-face	00:00	15%	5 / 10	CG15 CE50
9	Writing an application letter. Second non-recoverable task.	Individual work	Face-to-face	00:00	10%	5 / 10	CG13
10	In -class participation and activities of various kinds.	Group work	Face-to-face	00:00	%	/ 10	
11	In-class participation in activities of various kinds	Individual work	Face-to-face	00:00	%	/ 10	
12	Mock job interview: Third non-recoverable task	Group presentation	Face-to-face	00:00	10%	5 / 10	
13	In-class participation of activities of various kinds	Group presentation	Face-to-face	00:00	%	/ 10	
14	Oral presentations in groups: Second recoverable task	Group presentation	Face-to-face	00:00	15%	5 / 10	
14	Oral presentations in groups	Group presentation	Face-to-face	00:00	%	/ 10	
15	Oral presentations in groups	Group presentation	Face-to-face	00:00	%	/ 10	CG13

8.1.2. Global examination

Week	Description	Modality	Type	Duration	Weight	Minimum grade	Evaluated skills
17	Exam including all the content of the course.	Written test	Face-to-face	03:00	40%	5 / 10	CG13 CG15 CE50
17	Written proposal (also if failed or not delivered previously).	Written test	No Presential	00:00	15%	5 / 10	CG15 CE50
17	Oral presentation (also if failed or not delivered previously).	Other assessment	Face-to-face	00:00	15%	5 / 10	

8.1.3. Referred (re-sit) examination

Description	Modality	Type	Duration	Weight	Minimum grade	Evaluated skills
Global exam including all the course content.	Written test	Face-to-face	03:00	40%	5 / 10	CG15 CE50
Written proposal (if failed or not delivered previously).	Written test	Face-to-face	00:00	15%	5 / 10	CG15 CE50
Oral presentation (if failed or not delivered previously).	Other assessment	Face-to-face	00:00	15%	5 / 10	CG15 CE50

8.2. Assessment criteria

Progressive assessment

1. In-class active participation in practical activities (30%):

Students will have to take part actively in these individual and group activities along the semester. A global individual mark will be provided bearing in mind the student's participation in live sessions. These activities are compulsory and cannot be redone at the end of the semester. They include, among others: in-class activities (e.g., reading and analysis of texts, writing tasks), brief presentations (e.g., group written task), peer correction activities, mini-tests based on listening or reading activities, video CV presentations, job interviews, role-plays, games (Kahoot, Jeopardy), individual writing activities such as an abstract, summary, application letter, etc. These individual activities will be written in class and peer-reviewed as well. In order to comply with the assessment requirements, these productions will be graded randomly.

3. Group written task that can be redone (15%):

To pass the subject, students will be asked to complete a compulsory written task (e.g. a project proposal, a comparison of different texts or a functional-physical description of a product or system, according to the guidelines

established by the Department). These tasks must be submitted within the deadline set by the Department and can only be redone before the final exam date. The task to be redone, either because it was failed or because it was not submitted in due time, shall be submitted a week prior to the exam.

4. Group oral task that can be redone (15%):

To pass the subject, students will be asked to deliver an oral presentation in groups, according to the topics, dates and guidelines established by the Department. If it has to be redone, either because it was failed or it was not submitted and given in due time, the oral presentation shall be submitted a week prior to the exam regarding visual aids delivery. However, the oral presentation will be given on the same date of the Global exam. Prior to the exam, students will be informed about dates, assigned timing, rooms and teachers, as well as other issues regarding the delivery of the oral presentations. Additionally, the students may be asked some further questions on their presentation as well as on aspects related to the course syllabus (e.g. current studies, professional expectations, preferred corporate culture, etc.).

5. Written test (40%):

Reading, listening, writing and use of English test covering all the aspects worked on in class. All the exam parts must be separately passed. Failing one of the exam parts implies retaking the full exam again in the extraordinary call.

Both the written and oral tasks and the written test must be PASSED separately to PASS the subject. Besides, the scores obtained together will have to sum up a minimum of 50% of the total grade of the subject. Students are reminded that plagiarism or copying in any part of the exam will mean FAILING the subject.

Global assessment

Ordinary call:

- A written test that includes all the contents of the course (40%): Reading, listening, writing and use of English test covering all the aspects worked on during the course.
- Written proposal (15%)
- 5/6-minute presentation (15%)

The written test and the written and oral tasks must be PASSED separately to PASS the subject. Besides, the scores obtained together will have to sum up a minimum of 50% of the total grade of the subject. Failing the written task and/or one of the exam parts implies retaking the full exam again in the extraordinary call. Students are reminded that plagiarism or copying in any part of the exam will mean FAILING the subject.

Extraordinary call:

- A written test that includes all the contents of the course (40%): Reading, listening, writing and use of English test covering all the aspects worked on during the course.
- Written proposal (15%), in groups if possible.
- 5/6-minute presentation (15%)
- Individual writing activities (30%): students will be asked to submit 3 writings: an application letter, an abstract, and a summary. If any of these texts are found to have been generated by AI tools, the student will fail this component.

The written test, the individual writing activities, and the written and oral tasks must be PASSED separately to PASS the subject. Besides, the scores obtained together will have to sum up a minimum of 50% of the total grade of the subject. Failing the written task and/or one of the exam parts implies FAILING the subject. Students are reminded that plagiarism or copying in any part of the exam will mean failing the subject.

The assessment will check whether students have acquired the competences of the subject. Therefore, the assessment in the extraordinary call will use the same types of assessment techniques that are used in the assessment of the ordinary call.

IMPORTANT NOTES FOR ORDINARY AND EXTRAORDINARY CALLS:

- Students without a B2 level certificate must certify a B2 level of ENGLISH 5 days prior to the global exam; otherwise, they will be not allowed to do the written test. Besides, they will be assessed with "FAIL" (4/10) in the progressive assessment tasks until they provide the valid B2 level certificate required in order to pass the course. Once they provide a valid B2 level certificate, their tasks will be re-assessed with the corresponding mark.

- Global assessment in the ordinary call is scored with 70% because 30% corresponds to in-class participation in face-to-face activities that are non-recoverable, which means that they cannot be re-done given their practical essence and the interaction factor included; this is the reason why in order to assess the ability to communicate and the soft skills associated to this course, active class attendance is deemed essential. However, students taking the extraordinary call are subject to 100% of the mark.
- Some tasks as well as some exercises in the written test are based on open-ended questions and cannot be given a model answer within a time deadline.
- The use of Internet and electronic sources during the ordinary and extraordinary exam is forbidden and this will imply failing the subject.
- **Any assessment or submission made may require further oral assessment by the teacher to validate that it has been done by the student on her/his own, and not by an AI system.**

9. Teaching resources

9.1. Teaching resources for the subject

Name	Type	Notes
Moodle	Web resource	All the materials used in the course, exercises and class materials will be available on the platform
M. Hewings: Cambridge Academic English. Upper Intermediate. Cambridge:2012	Bibliography	An integrated skills course for EAP
C. Downes: Cambridge English for Job-hunting. Cambridge: 2014	Bibliography	Professional English Series
P. Emmerson: Business Vocabulary Builder. MacMillan, 2009	Bibliography	The words and phrases you need to succeed.
M. Powell: Presenting in English. Thomson/Heinle, 2002	Bibliography	How to give successful presentations
E. Williams: Presentations in English. MacMillan: 2008	Bibliography	Find your voice as a presenter
J. Hughes & A. Mallet: Successful meetings Oxford OUP 2013	Bibliography	DVD and Student's Book Pack
S. Bombardó et al.: Technical Writing Guide for Effective Communication, Barcelona UPC 2008	Bibliography	
M. Badecka-Kozikowska: English for Students of Electronics and Telecommunications. Gdansk, Wydawnictwo Politechniki Gdanskiej, 2015	Bibliography	
D. Barber et al.: Perspectives (Advanced C1), Boston: National Geographic Learning, 2018	Bibliography	

BBC Learning English	Web resource	https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/
Wired Magazine	Web resource	https://www.wired.com/
Academic Phrasebank	Web resource	https://www.phrasebank.manchester.ac.uk/
Purdue Online Writing Lab	Web resource	https://www.phrasebank.manchester.ac.uk/
TED Talks	Web resource	https://www.ted.com/talks
Gamification resources: Kahoot, Jeopardy, Cosmobuzz	Web resource	

10. Other information

10.1. Other information about the subject

Note 1.- The timeline included in this guide is a preliminary plan of the contents which may be modified along the semester. The specified activity times are also approximate and may overlap with the time devoted to other types of activities.

Note 2.- The course will be taught in English.

Note 3.- Concerning the SDG, along the present course students will learn and practice the following contents, allocated along the teaching weeks:

SDGs N° 4 on Education, N° 5 on Gender Equality, N° 7 on Energy, and N° 9 on Industry, innovation and infrastructures, will be analyzed and applied by:

- 1- Increasing the number of citizens with the necessary technical and professional competences to access a fair employment and entrepreneurship (SDG 4)
- 2- Enabling all students to be able to acquire enough technical and professional knowledge to promote a sustainable development as present students and future professionals (SDG 4)
- 3- Providing content related to Corporate cultures of biomedical companies and Job searching with a special focus on green companies (SDGG 13) and gender equality (SDG 5).

4- Including some related topics in the exercises and materials used in class, such as:

- The application of robots to innovate in medicine and to achieve a more sustainable practice.
- The application of Information and Communication Tools to improve and achieve a sustainable health care system, or to contribute to face and control pandemic such as the COVID-19 one, or their applications to innovate in the agriculture sector and the education sector with special focus on underdeveloped countries, etc.

Note 4.- Communication with teachers. Students will communicate with their lecturers preferably via e-mail. Teachers will try to provide an answer within a maximum period of 72 hours (weekends and holidays excluded). Students are encouraged to use their corporate e-mail address (@alumnos.upm.es). If necessary, periodical communication with the class representatives will be held as a follow-up of the course. The language policy for this communication will be English.

Note 5.- Platforms. The platform used for uploading materials and communication with students will be Moodle. Tasks should be handed in using this platform (rather than e-mail). For on-line tutorials, the preferred platform will be Zoom.